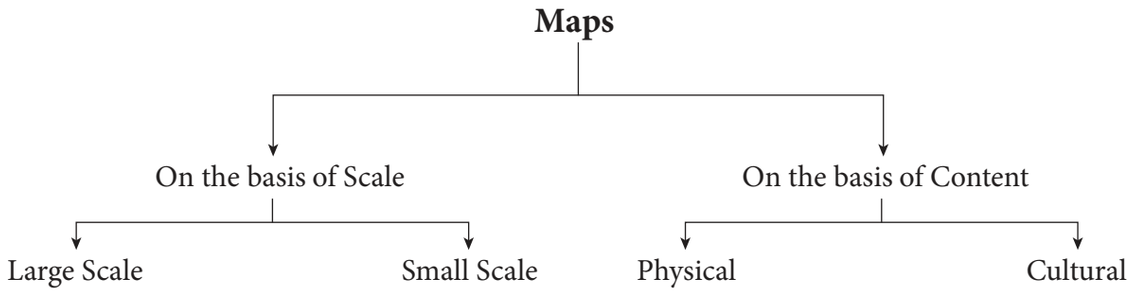
Types of Maps

As each map is unique in its design, content and construction. On the basis of certain common features maps can be classified into several types.



Maps on the basis of scale:

Large scale maps show small areas in greater details because they are drawn on a relatively large scale.

- **Cadastral maps** are village and town maps which show individual fields and house sites.
- **Topographical maps** shows smaller areas in much greater details about small area. These maps are prepared by Survey of India. These are also large scale maps which show both natural features like hills and valleys as well as man-made features like buildings, road and canals.

Small scale maps that show large areas like continent or countries. These maps are drawn on 1cm = 1000 kms. These are called small-scale maps.

- **Wall maps** are small-scale maps showing large areas. They are useful for students in classrooms and offices, small scale maps covers a larger area and depicts with limited information.
- **Atlas** is a collection of maps in a book. Atlas maps are small-scale maps covering large areas like continents and countries. Only prominent relief features, main roads and railways important towns are shown in Atlas maps. The study of geographic characteristics of a large area is possible at the time with the help of an atlas.

The science of map-making is called cartography (carte means 'map' and graphic means 'drawing').One who draws maps is called a Cartographer.

Types of Atlas

- **School Atlas** contains the maps giving sufficient details of the home and country.
- **Advanced Atlas** contains detailed maps of even small regions of the continents and are used as reference atlases.
- **Regional Atlas** contains detailed maps of small areas, prepared with a view to help in regional planning.
- **National Atlas** contains detailed maps of a country. The maps of a national atlas are comparatively large-sized and they depict general and characteristic features of the geography of a country.

Maps on the basis of content

Physical maps show natural features such as relief, geology, soils, drainage, elements weather, and vegetation.

7th Social Science Geography Term 3 EM Unit 2.indd 166 26-10-2022 16:51:10